

Hypertrophy

14-Day Companion Diet

Coach- and chef-built nutrition for the 12-Week Mesocycle

- 14 unique days · 4 to 5 meals per day · every recipe different
- Macro-calibrated to training and rest days, scaled to bodyweight
- Two complete grocery lists with cost bands in US dollars
- Spice blends, sauces, batch-cook playbook, and swap matrix
- Eating out, travel, supplements, and troubleshooting included

Coach- and chef-built nutrition program engineered for the TJFit Hypertrophy 12-Week Mesocycle (5 sessions/wk, 70 min, Push/Pull/Legs/Upper/Lower). This is not a generic meal plan. Numbers are calibrated for an intermediate male lifter, ~75 kg reference body, training six days a week with one full rest day. Scale rules at the top. Cook the food. Hit the macros. Get bigger.

1. Overview & Macros

1.1 Estimating maintenance calories

Use Mifflin–St Jeor for resting metabolic rate (RMR), then apply an activity multiplier.

Mifflin–St Jeor (men): $RMR = (10 \times \text{kg}) + (6.25 \times \text{cm}) - (5 \times \text{age}) + 5$ **Mifflin–St Jeor (women):** $RMR = (10 \times \text{kg}) + (6.25 \times \text{cm}) - (5 \times \text{age}) - 161$

Activity multiplier for this program (5 lifting sessions + general daily walking, desk job): **1.55**.

Worked example — 80 kg, 180 cm, 28-year-old male: - $RMR = (10 \times 80) + (6.25 \times 180) - (5 \times 28) + 5 = 800 + 1125 - 140 + 5 = 1790 \text{ kcal}$ - Maintenance = $1790 \times 1.55 = 2775 \text{ kcal}$ - Hypertrophy surplus = +300 kcal → **Target = 3075 kcal/day**

Surplus prescription: **+200 kcal** if you carry visible bodyfat already, **+300 kcal** if you are lean and gaining slowly, **+400 kcal** only if you are a hardgainer with a measured 2-week weight stall. Hard cap: 450 g/week scale gain. Anything faster is fat.

1.2 Macro split — training days (5/wk)

40% carbs / 30% protein / 30% fat. Protein anchored at **2.0 g/kg**.

Tier	BW	kcal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Fat (g)
Light	65 kg	2600	145	260	87
Reference	80 kg	3075	175	308	103
Heavy	95 kg	3550	205	355	118

1.3 Macro split — rest days (1/wk)

Drop calories by ~250 kcal: carbs come down, fat stays moderate, protein unchanged. 30% carbs / 35% protein / 35% fat.

Tier	BW	kcal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Fat (g)
Light	65 kg	2350	145	180	92
Reference	80 kg	2825	175	215	110
Heavy	95 kg	3300	205	250	128

1.4 Meal timing

- 4 fixed meals + 1 optional post-workout shake on training days.
- Breakfast within 60 min of waking.
- Pre-workout snack 60–90 min before lifting: 40–60 g carbs + 25–30 g protein, low fat.
- Post-workout shake within 45 min: 35 g whey + 50 g carbs (banana + 30 g oats or 200 ml juice).
- Last meal 90 min before bed. Include 30–40 g slow protein (cottage cheese, casein, or Greek yogurt).
- Keep meals ~3 hours apart. Do not skip breakfast on training days.

1.5 Hydration, electrolytes, fiber, micronutrients

- Water: 35 ml/kg/day floor. 80 kg → 2.8 L. Add 500 ml per hour of training.
- Sodium: 3–5 g/day. Salt your food. Add 1 g (~½ tsp) into your pre-workout drink.
- Potassium: 3.5 g/day from bananas, potatoes, leafy greens, yogurt.
- Magnesium: 400 mg/day. Pumpkin seeds, almonds, dark chocolate, supplement if needed.
- Fiber: 14 g per 1000 kcal. ~40 g/day at 3000 kcal.
- Micronutrient floor: 2 fruits + 400 g vegetables daily, non-negotiable. One serving of leafy greens, one serving of cruciferous, one colored vegetable.

2. The 14-Day Meal Plan

All macros target the **80 kg reference tier (3075 kcal training / 2825 kcal rest)**. Scale linearly by bodyweight ratio (e.g. 95 kg = multiply gram weights by 1.19). Days 1–6, 8–13 = training. Day 7 and 14 = rest (lower carbs, higher fat ratio).

Meal slot key: **B** = Breakfast, **L** = Lunch, **P** = Pre-workout, **D** = Dinner, **S** = Optional post-workout shake.

Day 1 (Push) — Mediterranean

1B — Greek Yogurt Power Bowl | 620 kcal · P 45 · C 75 · F 15 - 350 g 2% Greek yogurt, 80 g rolled oats (dry), 1 banana (120 g), 20 g walnuts, 20 g honey, 5 g cinnamon, 80 g blueberries. - Cook time: 5 min. Easy. 1. Toast oats dry in a pan over medium heat 3 min until fragrant. 2. Layer yogurt in a bowl. 3. Slice banana over top. 4. Crush walnuts, scatter. 5. Drizzle honey, dust with cinnamon, finish with blueberries. - Seasoning: Ceylon cinnamon, pinch of flaky sea salt. - Alt: No walnuts → 25 g almonds. No blueberries → 100 g strawberries. - Coach note: Casein-dominant yogurt + slow oats blunts morning cortisol. Stable energy until lunch.

1L — Chicken Souvlaki Bowl | 780 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 20 - 180 g chicken thigh (skinless, boneless), 200 g cooked basmati rice (70 g dry), 150 g cucumber, 100 g cherry tomatoes, 80 g red onion, 100 g tzatziki, 10 ml olive oil, 1 lemon. - Cook time: 20 min. Easy. 1. Cube chicken, toss with oil, 1 tsp oregano, 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp salt, juice of ½ lemon. 2. Heat skillet on high. Sear chicken 4 min per side until 75 °C / 165 °F internal. 3. Cook rice in 140 ml water + pinch of salt, 18 min covered. 4. Dice cucumber and tomato. Slice onion thin. 5. Plate rice, chicken, vegetables. Spoon tzatziki. Finish with lemon juice. - Seasoning: Greek rub (oregano, paprika, garlic, lemon, salt). - Alt: Chicken

thigh → 200 g chicken breast. Basmati → 230 g cooked quinoa. - Coach note: Thigh meat has 30% more zinc and iron than breast. Better recovery for high-volume push days.

1P — Rice Cakes + Whey | 380 kcal · P 35 · C 50 · F 4 - 4 plain rice cakes (40 g), 25 g honey, 30 g whey isolate, 200 ml water. - 3 min. Easy. 1. Drizzle honey on rice cakes. 2. Shake whey with cold water in a shaker. 3. Drink shake, eat rice cakes 75 min before lifting. - Alt: Rice cakes → 80 g sourdough toast. Whey → 200 g 0% Greek yogurt. - Coach note: Fast carbs + fast protein. Low fat for gastric emptying.

1D — Lamb Kofta with Tabbouleh | 850 kcal · P 50 · C 70 · F 35 - 180 g lean ground lamb (10% fat), 60 g bulgur (dry), 1 bunch parsley (40 g), 1 tomato (120 g), ½ red onion (60 g), 15 ml olive oil, juice of 1 lemon, 30 g tahini, 1 pita (60 g). - 25 min. Medium. 1. Mix lamb with ½ tsp cumin, ½ tsp coriander, ½ tsp cinnamon, ½ tsp salt, ¼ tsp black pepper, grated ¼ onion. 2. Form into 6 logs around skewers. 3. Soak bulgur in 120 ml boiling water 12 min, drain. 4. Finely chop parsley, tomato, remaining onion. Fluff into bulgur with lemon and oil. 5. Grill kofta on high heat 3 min per side. 6. Mix tahini with 30 ml water, 1 clove garlic crushed, lemon juice, salt. 7. Serve kofta over tabbouleh with pita and tahini sauce. - Seasoning: Shawarma-adjacent (cumin, coriander, cinnamon, black pepper). - Alt: Lamb → 180 g 90% lean beef. Bulgur → 70 g dry couscous. - Coach note: Heme iron + creatine from lamb beats chicken on Push days.

Day 2 (Pull) — Asian

2B — Japanese Tamago Rice Bowl | 600 kcal · P 40 · C 75 · F 14 - 3 large eggs, 200 g cooked short-grain rice, 30 g spinach, 10 ml sesame oil, 10 ml soy sauce, 5 g furikake, 1 spring onion. - 10 min. Easy. 1. Whisk eggs with 10 ml soy, pinch of sugar. 2. Heat half the sesame oil in a non-stick pan on medium-low. 3. Pour eggs in thirds, rolling each layer (tamago technique). Total 5 min. 4. Wilt spinach in remaining oil 60 sec. 5. Plate rice, slice tamago, top with spinach, furikake, spring onion. - Alt: Furikake → toasted sesame + ½ sheet crumbled nori. - Coach note: Egg yolks load choline; supports grip-intensive pulling.

2L — Korean Beef Bibimbap | 800 kcal · P 55 · C 85 · F 22 - 170 g lean beef sirloin, 200 g cooked rice, 80 g carrots, 80 g spinach, 60 g bean sprouts, 1 egg, 15 ml gochujang, 10 ml sesame oil, 10 ml soy, 1 clove garlic, 5 g sesame seeds. - 25 min. Medium. 1. Slice beef thin, marinate 10 min in soy, half the sesame oil, garlic, ½ tsp brown sugar. 2. Julienne carrots, sauté 3 min with salt. 3. Wilt spinach 60 sec in hot pan, squeeze dry. 4. Blanch sprouts 60 sec in salted boiling water. 5. Sear beef 90 sec per side in hot pan. 6. Fry egg sunny-side up. 7. Arrange rice, vegetables in zones, beef center, egg on top. 8. Mix gochujang with 5 ml sesame oil; spoon over. - Seasoning: Korean rub (gochujang, soy, sesame, garlic). - Alt: Sirloin → 180 g flank steak. Gochujang → 10 g sriracha + 5 g miso. - Coach note: Iron + B12 from sirloin supports erythropoiesis after high-volume pulling.

2P — Banana Oat Smoothie | 400 kcal · P 35 · C 55 · F 5 - 1 banana (120 g), 40 g oats, 30 g whey, 250 ml skim milk, ice. - 3 min. Easy. 1. Blend everything 30 sec. 2. Drink 75 min pre-workout. - Alt: Skim milk → 250 ml almond milk + 20 g extra whey. - Coach note: Cheap, repeatable, hits the macros without chewing.

2D — Thai Basil Chicken (Pad Krapow) | 820 kcal · P 55 · C 85 · F 25 - 180 g chicken thigh, 200 g cooked jasmine rice, 80 g green beans, 1 egg, 10 g garlic, 15 g Thai chili (or 5 g if heat-shy), 30 g Thai basil, 15 ml fish sauce, 10 ml oyster sauce, 5 g sugar, 15 ml peanut oil. - 15 min. Medium. 1. Mince chicken or chop very fine. Smash garlic and chili in a mortar. 2. Heat peanut oil in a wok until smoking. 3. Throw in garlic-chili paste 15 sec. 4. Add chicken, stir-fry 4 min until browned. 5. Add green beans, fish sauce, oyster sauce, sugar. 2 min. 6. Off heat, fold in basil. 7. Fry egg in second pan, crispy edges. 8. Plate rice, chicken, top with egg. - Seasoning: Thai trinity — fish sauce, oyster sauce, palm sugar. - Alt: Thai basil → Italian basil + ½ tsp anise seed. Chicken thigh → 180 g shrimp. - Coach note: Fish sauce delivers glutamic acid; deepens umami, helps appetite when chasing surplus.

Day 3 (Legs) — American

3B — Steak & Eggs | 700 kcal · P 55 · C 50 · F 28 - 150 g flank steak, 3 eggs, 2 slices sourdough (80 g), 100 g cherry tomatoes, 10 g butter, 5 g flaky salt. - 15 min. Easy. 1. Salt steak heavily, rest 5 min at room temp. 2. Sear in cast iron on high 2 min per side. Rest 4 min. 3. Soft scramble eggs in butter on low heat 4 min. 4. Toast sourdough. 5. Halve tomatoes, dust with salt. 6. Slice steak against grain, plate everything. - Seasoning: Black pepper, flaky sea salt, smoked paprika dust on the eggs. - Alt: Flank → 150 g sirloin tip. Sourdough → 80 g rye. - Coach note: Leg day demands ATP and creatine — front-load both before noon.

3L — Loaded Sweet Potato + Turkey Chili | 820 kcal · P 55 · C 95 · F 22 - 200 g sweet potato (1 large), 170 g lean ground turkey (93/7), 100 g black beans (drained), 80 g sweet corn, 80 g diced tomato, 30 g cheddar, 30 g sour cream, 10 g cilantro, 5 g taco blend (recipe in §5). - 35 min total (potato can be batched). Easy. 1. Bake whole sweet potato at 200 °C / 400 °F for 45 min (do this on prep day). 2. Brown turkey 5 min. 3. Add taco blend, beans, corn, tomato. Simmer 12 min. 4. Split potato, fluff flesh. 5. Top with chili, cheese, sour cream, cilantro. - Alt: Turkey → 170 g 93% lean beef. Sweet potato → 250 g baked white potato. - Coach note: Sweet potato glycemic curve is gentle — won't crash you before evening squats if eaten 4 h prior.

3P — PB&J on Bagel | 420 kcal · P 25 · C 60 · F 10 - 1 plain bagel (90 g), 20 g peanut butter, 20 g raspberry jam, 20 g whey mixed into 150 ml water. - 4 min. Easy. 1. Toast bagel. 2. Spread peanut butter on one half, jam on the other. 3. Drink whey on the side. - Alt: Bagel → 2 slices white bread. PB → 20 g almond butter. - Coach note: 60 g fast carbs is the floor for an evening leg session. Do not skip.

3D — Smash Burgers + Smashed Potatoes | 900 kcal · P 55 · C 75 · F 38 - 170 g 80/20 ground beef (2 patties), 1 brioche bun (70 g), 30 g cheddar, 60 g iceberg, 2 slices tomato, 20 g pickles, 15 g mustard, 250 g baby potatoes, 15 ml olive oil, 5 g rosemary. - 30 min. Medium. 1. Parboil potatoes 12 min in salted water. Drain, smash with the back of a glass. 2. Toss with oil, salt, rosemary. Roast at 220 °C / 425 °F for 18 min. 3. Form beef into 2 loose balls. Don't season yet. 4. Cast iron screaming hot. Smash each ball flat with a spatula for 90 sec. 5. Salt, flip 60 sec, cheese on, lid 30 sec. 6. Toast bun in beef fat. 7. Build: bun, mustard, pickles, patties, iceberg, tomato, bun. - Seasoning: Maldon salt, fresh black pepper. That's it — let the beef talk. - Alt: 80/20 beef → 170 g 85/15 + 10 g butter. Brioche → whole wheat bun. - Coach note: Highest-fat meal of the day after heaviest workout. Calorie payload + dopamine reward = adherence.

Day 4 (Upper) — Mexican

4B — Huevos Rancheros | 620 kcal · P 38 · C 60 · F 24 - 3 eggs, 2 corn tortillas (60 g), 100 g black beans, 80 g salsa roja, 50 g avocado, 20 g feta, 10 g cilantro, 1 lime. - 12 min. Easy. 1. Warm tortillas dry skillet 30 sec per side. 2. Heat beans with pinch of cumin, smash slightly. 3. Fry eggs in olive oil, crispy edges. 4. Layer: tortilla, beans, eggs, salsa, avocado, feta, cilantro, lime. - Seasoning: Toasted cumin, oregano, lime zest. - Alt: Corn → flour tortillas. Feta → 25 g queso fresco. - Coach note: Beans contribute leucine on top of egg protein — pushes total amino dose past 35 g.

4L — Chicken Burrito Bowl | 800 kcal · P 60 · C 90 · F 18 - 180 g chicken breast, 200 g cooked brown rice, 100 g black beans, 80 g sweet corn, 80 g pico de gallo, 50 g avocado, 30 g Greek yogurt (as crema), 15 g taco blend, 10 ml olive oil. - 20 min. Easy. 1. Slice chicken into strips, toss with taco blend, oil, salt. 2. Sear 4 min per side until 74 °C / 165 °F internal. 3. Warm rice, beans, corn separately. 4. Assemble bowl: rice base, beans, corn, chicken, pico, avocado, yogurt crema. - Seasoning: TJFit taco blend (§5.3). - Alt: Brown rice → cilantro-lime white rice. Chicken breast → 200 g grilled shrimp. - Coach note: Pre-portion this on Sunday — 3 of these per week kills decision fatigue.

4P — Tuna Wrap | 380 kcal · P 35 · C 45 · F 7 - 1 large tortilla (60 g), 1 can tuna in water (120 g drained), 15 g light mayo, 30 g cucumber, 30 g romaine, 5 g Dijon, pinch black pepper. - 5 min. Easy. 1. Mix tuna, mayo, mustard, pepper. 2. Layer on tortilla with cucumber and romaine. 3. Roll tight. - Alt: Tuna → 100 g shredded rotisserie chicken. Tortilla →

70 g pita. - Coach note: Cold meal, travels well, no excuses on busy training days.

4D — Carne Asada Tacos | 870 kcal · P 55 · C 80 · F 32 - 180 g flank or skirt steak, 3 corn tortillas (90 g), 60 g avocado, 80 g pico de gallo, 30 g cotija, 30 g cilantro, 1 lime, 10 ml olive oil, 200 g grilled bell peppers + onion. - 25 min. Medium. 1. Marinate steak in 30 ml lime juice, oil, 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp chili powder, 2 cloves garlic, salt — 15 min minimum. 2. Slice peppers and onion, char in pan 8 min. 3. Sear steak on rip-hot pan 3 min per side. Rest 5 min. 4. Warm tortillas directly over flame 10 sec each. 5. Slice steak against grain. 6. Build tacos: tortilla, steak, peppers, pico, avocado, cotija, cilantro, lime. - Seasoning: Cumin, ancho chili, lime, garlic. - Alt: Flank → 180 g skirt. Cotija → 30 g feta. - Coach note: Acid + iron + nitrate from peppers = recovery and vasodilation.

Day 5 (Lower) — Indian

5B — Masala Egg Bhurji on Toast | 640 kcal · P 42 · C 55 · F 28 - 3 eggs, 2 slices whole-grain toast (80 g), 80 g tomato, 40 g red onion, 10 g ginger-garlic paste, 1 green chili, 5 g garam masala (\$5.3), 10 g butter, 10 g cilantro. - 12 min. Easy. 1. Melt butter, sauté onion 3 min. 2. Add ginger-garlic, chili, 30 sec. 3. Add tomato, garam masala, salt — cook 3 min to a jammy paste. 4. Whisk eggs, pour in, scramble on low 3 min. 5. Top with cilantro, serve on toast. - Alt: Whole-grain → 70 g whole wheat paratha. - Coach note: Turmeric in garam masala has measurable anti-inflammatory effect at 200+ mg/day. Stack with leg day.

5L — Chicken Tikka Rice | 820 kcal · P 60 · C 95 · F 18 - 180 g chicken thigh, 200 g cooked basmati, 80 g Greek yogurt (marinade), 5 g garam masala, 5 g paprika, 5 g ginger-garlic paste, 100 g cucumber raita (60 g cucumber + 40 g yogurt + mint), 10 ml ghee. - 30 min (15 active). Medium. 1. Marinate chicken in yogurt, masala, paprika, ginger-garlic, salt — minimum 20 min, ideally 4 h. 2. Cook rice with pinch of saffron and a cardamom pod. 3. Sear chicken in ghee on high 4 min per side. 4. Mix raita: grated cucumber, yogurt, mint, salt. 5. Plate rice, chicken, raita on the side. - Seasoning: Garam masala, smoked paprika, cardamom. - Alt: Chicken thigh → 180 g paneer (vegetarian — adjust protein with extra 20 g whey). - Coach note: Marinating in yogurt is functional, not aesthetic — lactic acid tenderizes and the protein loss is zero.

5P — Mango Lassi + Roti | 400 kcal · P 30 · C 55 · F 6 - 200 g mango pulp, 200 g 0% Greek yogurt, 150 ml water, 1 roti (50 g), 5 g honey, pinch cardamom. - 5 min. Easy. 1. Blend mango, yogurt, water, honey, cardamom. 2. Warm roti. 3. Eat together. - Alt: Mango → 200 g pineapple + extra 10 g honey. - Coach note: Cold pre-workout fluids in summer; quick-digesting carb spike from mango.

5D — Dal Tadka + Jeera Rice + Tandoori Salmon | 850 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 26 - 180 g salmon fillet, 200 g cooked basmati, 80 g toor dal (dry), 1 tomato, 1 onion, 10 g ginger-garlic, 1 tsp cumin seeds, 5 g garam masala, 10 g ghee, 5 g turmeric, 10 g cilantro, 1 lemon. - 35 min. Medium. 1. Rinse dal, pressure-cook with 240 ml water, turmeric, salt — 15 min. 2. Sauté onion in ghee with cumin seeds 4 min. 3. Add ginger-garlic, tomato, garam masala — cook 4 min. 4. Mix tadka into cooked dal, simmer 5 min. 5. Rub salmon with turmeric, paprika, salt, yogurt. Sear skin-down 4 min, flip 2 min. 6. Cook rice with whole cumin seeds. 7. Plate: rice base, dal pool, salmon on top, cilantro and lemon. - Seasoning: Tadka (cumin seed, mustard seed optional), garam masala. - Alt: Salmon → 180 g cod + 10 g extra ghee. - Coach note: Omega-3 from salmon directly improves muscle protein synthesis at 2+ g EPA/DHA/day (Smith 2011).

Day 6 (Push v2) — Middle Eastern

6B — Shakshuka with Feta | 620 kcal · P 38 · C 55 · F 28 - 3 eggs, 2 slices sourdough (80 g), 200 g crushed tomato, 80 g red pepper, 60 g onion, 30 g feta, 5 g cumin, 5 g paprika, 10 g harissa, 10 g olive oil, 10 g parsley. - 20 min. Easy. 1. Sauté onion and pepper in oil 6 min. 2. Add cumin, paprika, harissa, 30 sec. 3. Add tomato, salt, simmer 7 min. 4.

Make 3 wells, crack eggs in. Cover, low heat 5 min until whites set, yolks runny. 5. Crumble feta, parsley. Mop with toast. - Alt: Harissa → 5 g cayenne + 5 g tomato paste + 5 g smoked paprika. - Coach note: One-pan, four servings if you scale x2. Batch on Sunday.

6L — Falafel Bowl with Hummus | 800 kcal · P 45 · C 100 · F 24 - 6 baked falafel (180 g — see batch note), 200 g cooked couscous, 80 g hummus, 100 g cucumber-tomato salad, 30 g pickled cabbage, 10 g tahini drizzle, 1 pita. - 15 min (falafel batched). Easy. 1. Reheat falafel in oven 8 min at 180 °C / 350 °F. 2. Fluff couscous with lemon and olive oil. 3. Toss cucumber-tomato with salt, oil, lemon, mint. 4. Plate bowl: couscous, falafel, hummus, salad, pickled cabbage, tahini. - Alt: Couscous → 70 g dry quinoa. Pita → 80 g sourdough. - Coach note: Plant-protein day. Combine chickpea + grain for full amino profile. Adherence-friendly when the kitchen is closed.

6P — Date + Whey + Almonds | 380 kcal · P 35 · C 45 · F 8 - 4 medjool dates (80 g), 15 g almonds, 30 g whey in 250 ml water. - 2 min. Easy. 1. Pit dates, stuff with almonds. 2. Shake whey. 3. Eat 60 min pre-workout. - Alt: Dates → 1 banana + 15 g honey. - Coach note: Date glucose:fructose ratio is near-perfect for liver + muscle glycogen co-loading.

6D — Beef Shawarma Plate | 880 kcal · P 60 · C 80 · F 32 - 180 g beef sirloin, 200 g cooked rice, 100 g tomato-cucumber salad, 60 g hummus, 40 g toum (garlic sauce), 30 g pickled turnip, 15 g shawarma rub (\$5.3), 10 ml olive oil. - 25 min (better if marinated overnight). Medium. 1. Slice beef thin against grain. 2. Coat in shawarma rub, oil, lemon — marinate 30 min. 3. Sear in cast iron on max heat, single layer, 90 sec per side. 4. Warm rice, plate. 5. Add salad, hummus, toum, pickles. - Seasoning: Shawarma rub (\$5.3). - Alt: Beef → 180 g chicken thigh. Toum → tzatziki. - Coach note: Saturday push depletion — high carb + iron rebuild for tomorrow's rest.

Day 7 (Rest) — Mediterranean light

7B — Smoked Salmon Plate | 520 kcal · P 40 · C 30 · F 24 - 100 g smoked salmon, 2 slices rye toast (70 g), 60 g avocado, 30 g cream cheese, 20 g red onion, 10 g capers, 1 lemon, dill. - 8 min. Easy. 1. Toast rye. 2. Spread cream cheese. 3. Layer salmon, avocado, onion, capers, dill, lemon. - Alt: Smoked salmon → 3 poached eggs. - Coach note: Front-load omega-3 on rest day for recovery.

7L — Tuna Niçoise Salad | 720 kcal · P 55 · C 50 · F 32 - 160 g seared tuna steak (or 2 cans drained), 150 g new potatoes, 80 g green beans, 2 eggs (hard-boiled), 80 g cherry tomato, 60 g olives, 30 g anchovy, 15 ml olive oil, 10 ml red wine vinegar, Dijon. - 25 min. Medium. 1. Boil potatoes 15 min, beans 4 min in same water. 2. Boil eggs 8 min, ice bath, peel, halve. 3. Sear tuna 90 sec per side rare (or use canned). 4. Whisk vinaigrette: oil, vinegar, Dijon, salt. 5. Plate everything in zones over greens. - Alt: Tuna steak → 160 g canned tuna in oil. - Coach note: Rest day = lean fats and protein density. Holds you full without surplus carbs.

7D — Ribeye + Roasted Vegetables | 850 kcal · P 60 · C 35 · F 55 - 220 g ribeye, 200 g asparagus, 150 g zucchini, 150 g cherry tomato, 20 g butter, 15 ml olive oil, garlic, rosemary, flaky salt. - 30 min. Medium. 1. Salt ribeye 40 min before, rest at room temp. 2. Toss vegetables in oil, salt, garlic. Roast at 220 °C / 425 °F for 15 min. 3. Sear steak in cast iron 3 min per side. Baste last minute with butter, garlic, rosemary. 4. Rest 8 min. Slice against grain. - Seasoning: Maldon, black pepper, rosemary. - Alt: Ribeye → 220 g NY strip + 10 g extra butter. - Coach note: No pre-workout meal today. Three big meals. Higher fat keeps satiety locked.

Day 8 (Pull v2) — Japanese

8B — Salmon Onigiri + Miso Soup | 580 kcal · P 38 · C 75 · F 12 - 200 g cooked sushi rice (3 onigiri), 80 g grilled salmon, 1 nori sheet, 1 sachet miso (or 15 g paste), 1 egg, 30 g spinach. - 15 min (rice batched). Easy. 1. Flake

salmon, mix with pinch of salt. 2. Wet hands, form 3 rice triangles around salmon. 3. Wrap with nori strips. 4. Whisk miso into 300 ml hot water, drop spinach in. 5. Soft-boil egg 6 min, half into miso. - Alt: Salmon → 80 g tuna mixed with 10 g Kewpie mayo. - Coach note: Cold breakfast portable; ideal if you train early and eat post-AM.

8L — Soba Noodle Salad with Edamame & Chicken | 780 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 18 - 100 g dry soba, 170 g chicken breast, 100 g edamame, 60 g carrot, 60 g cabbage, 20 g sesame, 15 ml soy, 10 ml sesame oil, 10 ml rice vinegar, 5 g ginger, 5 g honey. - 20 min. Easy. 1. Cook soba 5 min, rinse cold. 2. Poach chicken 12 min in salted water, shred. 3. Steam edamame 4 min. 4. Whisk dressing: soy, sesame oil, vinegar, ginger, honey. 5. Toss everything with sesame seeds. - Alt: Soba → 100 g rice noodles. Edamame → 100 g chickpeas. - Coach note: Buckwheat soba has 13 g protein per 100 g — exceptionally high for a noodle.

8P — Banana + Rice Cake + Whey | 390 kcal · P 32 · C 55 · F 4 - 1 banana, 3 rice cakes, 30 g whey, 200 ml water, 5 g honey. - 3 min. Easy. 1. Mash banana on rice cakes. 2. Drizzle honey. 3. Drink whey. - Coach note: Cheapest reliable pre-workout in the plan.

8D — Teriyaki Glazed Cod + Stir-Fry Veg | 800 kcal · P 55 · C 80 · F 22 - 200 g cod, 200 g cooked rice, 100 g broccoli, 80 g bell pepper, 80 g mushroom, 30 ml teriyaki (15 ml soy + 10 ml mirin + 5 g sugar + 5 g ginger), 10 ml sesame oil, 15 g sesame. - 20 min. Easy. 1. Whisk teriyaki, simmer to syrup 3 min. 2. Sear cod 3 min per side, glaze last minute. 3. Stir-fry vegetables in sesame oil 5 min over high heat. Salt. 4. Plate rice, vegetables, cod, sesame seeds. - Alt: Cod → 200 g chicken thigh. - Coach note: White fish + rice = lowest-friction high-volume meal in the plan.

Day 9 (Legs v2) — American comfort

9B — Protein Pancakes + Bacon | 680 kcal · P 50 · C 70 · F 22 - 80 g oats blended into flour, 30 g whey, 2 eggs, 200 ml milk, 1 banana, 5 g baking powder, 3 strips turkey bacon, 30 g maple syrup, 20 g butter. - 15 min. Easy. 1. Blend oats, whey, eggs, milk, banana, baking powder, pinch salt. 2. Cook pancakes in butter, 90 sec per side. 3. Crisp bacon in second pan 5 min. 4. Stack, syrup, bacon on side. - Alt: Turkey bacon → 100 g chicken sausage. - Coach note: Sweet, high-protein, calorie-dense — leg-day fuel.

9L — Grilled Chicken Caesar Wrap | 760 kcal · P 55 · C 70 · F 24 - 180 g chicken breast, 1 large tortilla (80 g), 80 g romaine, 30 g Caesar dressing, 20 g parmesan, 20 g croutons, 1 lemon. - 15 min. Easy. 1. Season chicken with salt, pepper, garlic powder. Grill 5 min per side. 2. Slice chicken. 3. Toss romaine with dressing, parmesan, croutons. 4. Roll in tortilla. - Alt: Caesar dressing → 25 g Greek yogurt + 1 anchovy + Dijon + lemon. - Coach note: Quick lunch when training mid-afternoon.

9P — Honey-Mustard Pretzels + Whey | 400 kcal · P 33 · C 60 · F 5 - 60 g pretzels, 25 g honey mustard, 30 g whey, 200 ml water. - 2 min. - Coach note: Salt + carbs = vascular pump. Eat it.

9D — BBQ Pulled Chicken Sandwich + Sweet Potato Fries | 850 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 24 - 180 g shredded chicken thigh, 1 brioche bun, 40 g BBQ sauce, 60 g coleslaw, 200 g sweet potato cut into fries, 15 ml olive oil, 5 g paprika. - 35 min (chicken batched). Medium. 1. Toss potato fries in oil, paprika, salt. Roast at 220 °C / 425 °F, 25 min. 2. Heat shredded chicken with BBQ sauce 5 min. 3. Quick slaw: 60 g cabbage, 10 g mayo, 5 g vinegar, salt. 4. Toast bun. 5. Build: bun, chicken, slaw, bun. - Alt: Chicken → 180 g pulled pork shoulder (lean). - Coach note: High glycemic + protein post-leg day refills glycogen fastest.

Day 10 (Upper v2) — Italian

10B — Ricotta Toast + Berries | 620 kcal · P 38 · C 70 · F 20 - 2 slices sourdough (80 g), 150 g ricotta, 100 g berries, 30 g honey, 20 g almonds, 5 g lemon zest, mint. - 7 min. Easy. 1. Toast bread. 2. Spread ricotta, top with berries, almonds, honey, zest, mint. - Alt: Ricotta → 150 g cottage cheese. - Coach note: Whole-milk ricotta is calorie-dense and slow-protein.

10L — Tuna Pasta Salad | 770 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 18 - 100 g dry penne, 160 g canned tuna, 80 g cherry tomato, 60 g olives, 40 g red onion, 30 g feta, 80 g arugula, 15 ml olive oil, 10 ml red wine vinegar, oregano. - 15 min. Easy. 1. Boil pasta 9 min, rinse cold. 2. Toss with tuna, vegetables, feta, oil, vinegar, oregano. - Alt: Tuna → 170 g cooked chicken breast. - Coach note: Cold pasta has 20% lower glycemic load thanks to resistant starch.

10P — Espresso + Bagel + Cottage Cheese | 410 kcal · P 32 · C 55 · F 6 - 1 bagel, 100 g cottage cheese, 15 g honey, espresso. - 5 min. - Coach note: Caffeine 90 min pre-workout for upper-day strength.

10D — Spaghetti Bolognese | 880 kcal · P 55 · C 95 · F 26 - 100 g dry spaghetti, 180 g lean ground beef (90/10), 200 g passata, 60 g onion, 60 g carrot, 60 g celery, 2 cloves garlic, 15 ml olive oil, 30 g parmesan, oregano, basil, bay leaf. - 35 min. Medium. 1. Dice onion, carrot, celery very fine — soffritto. 2. Sauté in oil 10 min on low. 3. Brown beef 5 min. Salt. 4. Add passata, garlic, bay, oregano. Simmer 15 min. 5. Cook pasta al dente. Reserve 50 ml pasta water. 6. Toss pasta in sauce with water, parmesan, basil. - Seasoning: Italian herb mix (\$5.3). - Alt: Beef → 180 g ground turkey + 5 g extra oil. - Coach note: Slow-simmered ragù has higher glutamate density — better appetite trigger when chasing surplus.

Day 11 (Lower v2) — Mexican v2

11B — Breakfast Burrito | 680 kcal · P 45 · C 70 · F 24 - 1 large tortilla (80 g), 3 eggs, 80 g black beans, 50 g cheddar, 60 g salsa, 50 g avocado, 30 g chorizo (lean), 10 g cilantro. - 12 min. Easy. 1. Cook chorizo 4 min. 2. Scramble eggs in chorizo fat 3 min. 3. Warm beans and tortilla. 4. Build: beans, eggs+chorizo, cheese, salsa, avocado, cilantro. Roll. - Alt: Chorizo → 30 g turkey sausage. - Coach note: Heaviest lift day, biggest breakfast.

11L — Shrimp Ceviche Tostadas | 720 kcal · P 50 · C 70 · F 20 - 200 g shrimp, 3 tostadas (60 g), 80 g mango, 60 g cucumber, 40 g red onion, 80 g avocado, 1 lime, cilantro, jalapeño. - 20 min. Easy. 1. Poach shrimp 2 min, ice bath, chop. 2. Marinate in lime juice 10 min. 3. Dice mango, cucumber, onion, avocado, jalapeño. 4. Mix, salt, cilantro. 5. Pile on tostadas. - Alt: Shrimp → 200 g cooked white fish. - Coach note: Pre-leg-day, low-fat, hyper-digestible.

11P — Mexican Hot Chocolate + Toast | 400 kcal · P 30 · C 55 · F 7 - 250 ml milk, 20 g cocoa, 15 g sugar, pinch cinnamon, pinch cayenne, 30 g whey, 2 slices toast, 15 g jam. - 5 min. - Coach note: Cocoa flavanols improve blood flow at 200+ mg dose.

11D — Chile Verde Chicken + Rice & Beans | 880 kcal · P 60 · C 95 · F 22 - 180 g chicken thigh, 200 g cooked rice, 100 g black beans, 100 g tomatillo salsa (verde), 50 g avocado, 30 g cotija, cilantro, lime. - 35 min (verde batched). Medium. 1. Brown chicken 4 min per side. 2. Pour verde over, simmer 15 min until 75 °C / 165 °F. 3. Heat beans with cumin, salt. 4. Plate rice, beans, chicken with sauce, avocado, cotija, lime. - Seasoning: Roasted tomatillo, jalapeño, garlic, cilantro, cumin. - Alt: Verde → store-bought salsa verde. - Coach note: Tomatillos = vitamin C + acidic protein tenderization.

Day 12 (Push v3) — Mediterranean v2

12B — Mediterranean Omelet | 620 kcal · P 42 · C 50 · F 28 - 3 eggs, 60 g feta, 80 g spinach, 40 g sun-dried tomato, 80 g sourdough, 10 g olive oil, oregano. - 10 min. Easy. 1. Wilt spinach in oil 60 sec. 2. Pour beaten eggs over, low

heat 3 min. 3. Add feta, tomato, oregano. Fold. 4. Toast bread.

12L — Salmon Poke Bowl | 800 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 22 - 180 g sashimi-grade salmon, 200 g cooked rice, 80 g edamame, 60 g cucumber, 60 g mango, 30 g avocado, 20 g seaweed salad, 10 g sesame, 15 ml soy, 5 ml sesame oil. - 12 min. Easy. 1. Cube salmon, toss with soy, sesame oil, sesame. 2. Plate rice, salmon, edamame, cucumber, mango, avocado, seaweed. - Alt: Salmon → seared instead of raw if quality uncertain. - Coach note: Highest-quality fat day in the plan; load omega-3.

12P — Yogurt + Granola + Honey | 400 kcal · P 35 · C 55 · F 6 - 250 g 0% Greek yogurt, 50 g low-fat granola, 20 g honey, 1 banana. - 3 min.

12D — Grilled Branzino + Lemon Potatoes + Greek Salad | 820 kcal · P 55 · C 75 · F 28 - 200 g branzino (whole or fillet), 250 g baby potatoes, 100 g cucumber, 80 g tomato, 60 g red onion, 60 g feta, 40 g olives, 15 ml olive oil, 2 lemons, oregano. - 35 min. Medium. 1. Toss potatoes in oil, salt, oregano, lemon juice. Roast at 220 °C / 425 °F, 25 min. 2. Score branzino, salt inside, stuff with lemon and oregano. 3. Grill 4 min per side. 4. Greek salad: chop cucumber, tomato, onion, olives, feta. Oil, oregano, salt.

Day 13 (Pull v3) — Asian fusion

13B — Congee with Soft Egg + Pork Floss | 580 kcal · P 35 · C 75 · F 14 - 80 g rice (dry), 600 ml chicken stock, 1 egg, 20 g pork floss (or shredded chicken 60 g), 10 g ginger, spring onion, sesame oil, soy. - 30 min (do overnight in slow cooker). Easy. 1. Simmer rice in stock 25 min until porridge consistency. 2. Soft-boil egg 6 min. 3. Top congee with egg, floss, ginger, spring onion, drizzle sesame + soy. - Alt: Pork floss → 100 g shredded rotisserie chicken.

13L — Vietnamese Pho Bo | 780 kcal · P 55 · C 90 · F 18 - 100 g dry rice noodles, 160 g sliced beef sirloin, 800 ml beef stock, 60 g bean sprouts, 30 g Thai basil, 20 g cilantro, 1 lime, 5 g ginger, 2 star anise, 1 cinnamon stick, 1 onion charred, fish sauce, hoisin, sriracha. - 30 min (broth batched). Medium. 1. Simmer stock with spices, onion, ginger 20 min. Strain. 2. Cook noodles 3 min. 3. Place raw thin-sliced beef in bowl, pour boiling broth over to cook. 4. Garnish with sprouts, basil, cilantro, lime. - Coach note: Hot broth + sodium + collagen = excellent recovery meal.

13P — Sticky Rice + Egg Whites + Honey | 400 kcal · P 32 · C 60 · F 4 - 80 g cooked sticky rice, 200 g liquid egg whites, 20 g honey, soy sauce. - 5 min.

13D — Black Pepper Beef Stir-Fry | 840 kcal · P 55 · C 85 · F 26 - 180 g beef sirloin, 200 g cooked rice, 100 g bell pepper, 80 g onion, 60 g broccoli, 20 g oyster sauce, 10 ml soy, 10 ml dark soy, 5 g sugar, 10 g black pepper (coarse), 15 ml peanut oil, 5 g cornstarch. - 15 min. Medium. 1. Toss sliced beef in cornstarch, soy. 2. Wok screaming hot, oil, beef — 90 sec, remove. 3. Vegetables 3 min. 4. Beef back in. Oyster sauce, dark soy, sugar, pepper. 90 sec.

Day 14 (Rest v2) — Mixed

14B — Cottage Cheese + Smoked Salmon Bagel | 540 kcal · P 45 · C 50 · F 18 - 1 bagel, 100 g cottage cheese, 80 g smoked salmon, 20 g red onion, 10 g capers, dill.

14L — Roast Chicken Salad | 700 kcal · P 55 · C 35 · F 36 - 200 g rotisserie chicken, 100 g mixed greens, 80 g cucumber, 80 g tomato, 60 g avocado, 30 g walnuts, 30 g blue cheese, balsamic vinaigrette.

14D — Beef Stir-Fry over Cauliflower Rice + Berries Dessert | 860 kcal · P 60 · C 35 · F 55 - 220 g beef sirloin, 200 g cauliflower rice, 100 g broccoli, 80 g pepper, 20 g almonds, 15 ml peanut oil, 15 ml soy. Dessert: 150 g berries + 30 g dark chocolate + 30 g whipped cream.

3. Master Grocery List

Week 1 (Days 1–7) — 80 kg reference tier

Proteins - Chicken thigh, boneless skinless: 900 g - Chicken breast: 360 g - Lean ground turkey (93/7): 170 g - Flank/skirt steak: 480 g - Beef sirloin: 180 g - Ground beef 80/20: 170 g - Lean ground lamb (10%): 180 g - Eggs: 18 large - Salmon fillet: 180 g - Smoked salmon: 100 g - Tuna steak: 160 g - Canned tuna (water): 1 can (120 g drained) - Greek yogurt 0%: 800 g - Greek yogurt 2%: 350 g - Feta: 100 g - Whey isolate: 200 g (~6 scoops)

Carbohydrates - Basmati rice: 600 g dry - Brown rice: 200 g dry - Short-grain (sushi) rice: 150 g dry - Bulgur: 60 g - Oats rolled: 200 g - Sourdough loaf: 1 (~600 g) - Rye bread: 4 slices - Pita: 2 - Corn tortillas: 5 - Flour tortilla large: 1 - Brioche bun: 1 - Bagel: 1 - Rice cakes: 8 - Honey: 100 g - Maple syrup: 30 g - Sweet potato: 1 large (200 g) - Baby potatoes: 250 g - New potatoes: 150 g

Fruits - Bananas: 4 - Blueberries: 80 g - Strawberries or berries: 100 g - Medjool dates: 4 - Lemons: 6 - Limes: 3

Fats - Extra virgin olive oil: 150 ml - Sesame oil: 30 ml - Peanut oil: 20 ml - Ghee: 20 g - Butter: 50 g - Avocados: 2 - Walnuts: 20 g - Almonds: 20 g - Tahini: 60 g - Peanut butter: 20 g

Vegetables - Spinach: 200 g - Asparagus: 200 g - Broccoli: 100 g - Green beans: 80 g - Bell peppers: 280 g (mixed) - Carrots: 80 g - Cherry tomatoes: 500 g - Cucumber: 350 g - Red onion: 400 g - Yellow onion: 2 - Zucchini: 150 g - Bean sprouts: 60 g - Parsley: 1 bunch - Cilantro: 1 bunch - Mint: ½ bunch - Thai basil: 30 g (or sub) - Spring onion: 1 bunch - Garlic: 1 head - Ginger: 50 g knob - Thai chili / jalapeño: 2

Dairy - Cheddar: 60 g - Cotija or feta: 30 g - Parmesan: 30 g - Cream cheese: 30 g - Skim milk: 500 ml

Pantry / Spices (one-time stock) - Soy sauce, fish sauce, oyster sauce, gochujang, hoisin - Olive oil, sesame oil, peanut oil, ghee - Tomato passata, crushed tomato, tomato paste - Hummus tub, tzatziki tub - Mustard (Dijon), mayo, BBQ sauce - Cumin (whole + ground), coriander seed, garam masala, smoked paprika, oregano, rosemary, thyme, cinnamon, cardamom, turmeric, chili powder, black pepper, kosher salt, flaky sea salt, bay leaves, star anise, ginger powder, garlic powder, harissa paste

Optional / Supplements - Creatine monohydrate (300 g tub) - Vitamin D3 (4000 IU softgels) - Omega-3 fish oil (EPA+DHA ≥ 1 g/serving) - Electrolyte powder

Estimated weekly cost (USD) - Low (discount supermarket, US Midwest/EU outside capitals): **\$80–110** - Medium (Whole Foods light, UK Sainsbury's, Trader Joe's): **\$120–160** - High (organic/grass-fed, urban premium): **\$180–240**

Week 2 (Days 8–14)

Proteins - Chicken breast: 350 g - Chicken thigh: 360 g - Rotisserie chicken: 1 (~1.2 kg) - Beef sirloin: 580 g - Lean ground beef 90/10: 180 g - Salmon, sashimi-grade: 180 g - Branzino (or sea bass): 1 (200 g fillet) - Cod: 200 g - Shrimp: 200 g - Smoked salmon: 80 g - Tuna, canned: 160 g - Pork floss: 20 g (or sub chicken) - Chorizo, lean: 30 g - Eggs: 18 - Cottage cheese: 250 g - Greek yogurt: 600 g - Feta: 120 g - Ricotta: 150 g - Cotija: 30 g - Parmesan: 30 g - Whey isolate: 150 g

Carbohydrates - Basmati: 200 g dry - Jasmine: 200 g dry - Sushi rice: 150 g dry - Penne: 100 g - Spaghetti: 100 g - Soba: 100 g - Rice noodles: 100 g - Oats: 80 g - Sourdough: 1 loaf - Bagels: 2 - Brioche bun: 1 - Large tortilla: 2 - Tostadas: 3 - Sweet potato: 200 g - Baby potatoes: 250 g - Sticky rice: 80 g - Granola: 50 g - Pretzels: 60 g

Fruits - Bananas: 3 - Mango: 1 - Berries (mixed): 250 g - Lemons: 5 - Limes: 5

Fats - Olive oil, sesame oil, peanut oil — replenish as needed - Butter: 40 g - Avocados: 4 - Almonds: 50 g - Walnuts: 30 g - Dark chocolate 85%: 30 g

Vegetables - Mixed greens, romaine, arugula: 400 g total - Cabbage: 200 g - Bell peppers: 200 g - Broccoli: 200 g - Onion (red + yellow): 4 total - Tomato + cherry tomato: 500 g - Cucumber: 400 g - Edamame: 200 g - Carrots: 60 g - Mushrooms: 80 g - Cauliflower rice: 200 g - Tomatillos (or jarred verde): 100 g - Seaweed salad: 20 g - Nori sheets: 5 - Sun-dried tomato: 40 g - Olives: 100 g - Capers: 20 g

Pantry: replenish soy/fish sauce, vinegar, BBQ, salsa verde, hoisin, sriracha, harissa, miso paste.

Dairy - Mozzarella or blue cheese: 30 g - Whole milk: 500 ml

Cost band same as Week 1.

4. Meal-Swap Matrix

Meals within a group are macro-equivalent ($\pm 5\%$). Swap freely.

Breakfast group (~620 kcal, P40 / C60 / F22)

- 1B Greek Yogurt Bowl
- 2B Japanese Tamago Bowl
- 4B Huevos Rancheros
- 5B Masala Egg Bhurji
- 6B Shakshuka
- 8B Salmon Onigiri (lower fat)
- 10B Ricotta Toast
- 12B Mediterranean Omelet

Higher-cal breakfast (~680 kcal — leg/upper days)

- 3B Steak & Eggs
- 9B Protein Pancakes
- 11B Breakfast Burrito

Lunch group (~780 kcal, P55 / C90 / F20)

- 1L Souvlaki Bowl
- 2L Bibimbap
- 4L Burrito Bowl
- 5L Chicken Tikka
- 6L Falafel Bowl

- 8L Soba Salad
- 10L Tuna Pasta Salad
- 12L Salmon Poke
- 13L Pho Bo

Lower-carb lunch (~720 kcal, rest days)

- 7L Tuna Niçoise
- 11L Shrimp Ceviche Tostadas
- 14L Roast Chicken Salad

Pre-workout (~400 kcal, P32 / C55 / F5)

- All P slots are interchangeable. Eat anything in the list 60–90 min pre.

Dinner group (~860 kcal, P55 / C85 / F28)

- 1D Lamb Kofta
- 2D Pad Krapow
- 4D Carne Asada Tacos
- 5D Dal + Salmon
- 6D Beef Shawarma
- 8D Teriyaki Cod
- 9D BBQ Pulled Chicken
- 10D Bolognese
- 11D Chile Verde
- 12D Branzino + Potatoes
- 13D Black Pepper Beef

Higher-fat dinner (~870 kcal, rest days)

- 3D Smash Burgers
- 7D Ribeye + Vegetables
- 14D Beef + Cauliflower Rice

5. Cooking Primer

5.1 Sunday batch-cook (90 minutes total)

1. Rice (15 min hands-on, 20 cooking): 600 g basmati, 600 g jasmine. Store in airtight containers. Fridge 4 days, freezer 3 months.
2. Roast 1.5 kg chicken thighs (5 min prep, 35 oven): salt + olive oil + garlic at 200 °C / 400 °F. Pull at 75 °C / 165 °F internal.
3. Roast 1 sweet potato + 500 g baby potatoes: same oven, 40 min.
4. Hard-boil 6 eggs: rolling boil 8 min, ice bath, peel under water.
5. Make 1 sauce + 1 spice blend from below.
6. Pre-portion lunches into 5 containers.

5.2 Storage rules

Item	Fridge	Freezer
Cooked rice	4 days	3 months
Cooked chicken	4 days	3 months
Cooked beef	3 days	3 months
Cooked fish	2 days	2 months
Hard-boiled egg (peeled)	5 days	no
Pre-cut vegetables	3 days	no
Dressings/sauces	5–7 days	no (oil emulsions break)
Yogurt-based marinades	2 days	no
Cooked beans/lentils	5 days	3 months

5.3 Spice blends (make once, use everywhere)

Mix in 100 g batches, store in airtight jar 6 months.

1. Shawarma rub: 30 g cumin, 20 g coriander, 15 g paprika, 10 g turmeric, 10 g garlic powder, 5 g cinnamon, 5 g black pepper, 5 g cardamom.
2. Taco / fajita blend: 30 g chili powder, 20 g cumin, 15 g paprika, 10 g garlic powder, 10 g onion powder, 5 g oregano, 5 g black pepper, 5 g salt.
3. Garam masala: 25 g cumin, 25 g coriander, 15 g cardamom, 10 g cinnamon, 10 g black pepper, 5 g cloves, 5 g nutmeg, 5 g bay (ground).
4. Italian herb mix: 25 g oregano, 25 g basil, 20 g thyme, 15 g rosemary, 10 g marjoram, 5 g garlic powder.
5. Greek rub: 30 g oregano, 20 g garlic powder, 15 g onion powder, 15 g paprika, 10 g black pepper, 10 g salt.
6. Cajun blend: 25 g paprika, 20 g garlic powder, 15 g onion powder, 10 g cayenne, 10 g oregano, 10 g thyme, 10 g black pepper.
7. Steak rub: 40 g kosher salt, 30 g coarse black pepper, 15 g garlic powder, 10 g rosemary, 5 g brown sugar.

8. Korean BBQ rub (dry): 25 g brown sugar, 20 g garlic powder, 15 g ginger powder, 15 g gochugaru, 15 g sesame, 10 g salt.

5.4 Five universal sauces

1. Tahini sauce (200 g): 100 g tahini, 60 ml water, 30 ml lemon, 1 garlic clove crushed, $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp salt, $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp cumin. Use on bowls, kofta, falafel.
2. Peanut sauce (200 g): 80 g peanut butter, 30 ml soy, 30 ml lime, 20 ml warm water, 10 g honey, 5 g garlic, 5 g ginger, chili flakes. Use on stir-fry, noodles, satay.
3. Chimichurri (200 g): 1 bunch parsley fine-chopped, 4 cloves garlic, 100 ml olive oil, 30 ml red wine vinegar, 5 g oregano, 5 g chili flakes, $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp salt. Use on steak, eggs, potatoes.
4. Tzatziki (300 g): 200 g 0% Greek yogurt, 80 g grated cucumber (squeezed dry), 1 garlic clove crushed, 10 ml olive oil, 10 ml lemon, dill, salt. Use on souvlaki, lamb, vegetables.
5. Salsa verde (Mexican, 300 g): 6 tomatillos charred, 1 jalapeño, 2 cloves garlic, $\frac{1}{2}$ onion, 1 bunch cilantro, juice of 1 lime, salt. Blend. Use on chicken, fish, eggs.

6. Eating Out & Travel

Chipotle (~750 kcal, P55 / C85 / F20)

- Burrito bowl. Brown rice, black beans, double chicken, fajita vegetables, mild salsa, corn salsa, lettuce. Skip cheese OR sour cream (not both). Skip guacamole if hitting fat already.

Subway (~700 kcal, P50 / C75 / F20)

- 12-inch turkey + ham on whole grain. Double meat. All vegetables. Mustard + light mayo. No cheese, or one slice. Bag of baked chips.

Nando's

- Half chicken, butterfly. Medium spice. Sides: spicy rice + corn on the cob. Skip the chips on training days only if dinner has high carbs already.

Kebab shop

- Chicken or lamb shish plate (skewers, not döner — döner is fat-loaded). Salad, hummus, half a pita. Pass on the chili sauce drowning. Aim 250 g meat + 150 g rice + salad.

Sushi

- 2 rolls (salmon, tuna, or shrimp) + 1 piece nigiri x 6 + edamame + miso soup. Skip tempura. Light on soy. ~750 kcal, 50 g protein.

McDonald's (emergency)

- 2 plain grilled chicken sandwiches + apple slices + side salad with light vinaigrette. ~700 kcal, 55 g protein. Better than skipping a meal.

Travel fallback (airport or hotel)

- 2 × Greek yogurt cups (200 g each) + 1 banana + protein bar (≥ 20 g P, ≤ 10 g F).
- Pack 3 × 30 g whey single-serves, 2 × instant oats sachets.
- Hotel breakfast: 4 eggs + smoked salmon + 2 toast + fruit + yogurt. Hits 50+ g protein, repeatable.

7. Supplements

Tier 1 — proven, daily

- Creatine monohydrate, 5 g/day. Any time. Loading not needed. Increases muscle creatine 20–40%, output and lean mass measurable at 4 weeks (Kreider 2017, ISSN position stand).
- Whey protein, 25–40 g per serving as needed. Convenience, not magic. Use to hit daily protein floor.
- Vitamin D3, 2000–4000 IU/day (more in winter or if indoors). Test 25(OH)D, aim 30–50 ng/ml.
- Omega-3 (EPA+DHA), 2–3 g/day total. Supports muscle protein synthesis (Smith 2011) and inflammation.

Tier 2 — situational

- Caffeine, 3–6 mg/kg 45–60 min pre-workout. Skip if training after 18:00 or you're a slow metabolizer.
- Magnesium glycinate, 300–400 mg evening. Sleep + cramps.
- Electrolyte powder during sessions >60 min or hot environments. ~500 mg sodium + 200 mg potassium per liter.

Skip entirely

- BCAAs / EAAs powder. Redundant if you hit 1.8+ g/kg whole-food protein.
- Fat burners. Cost > benefit. Caffeine + diet does the same job.
- Testosterone boosters (tribulus, ZMA hype, ashwagandha at hypertrophy doses). Effects are too small or unproven to bank on. Sleep and protein move the needle further.
- Glutamine. No measurable benefit in non-clinical lifters.

8. Troubleshooting

Not gaining weight after 2 weeks

1. Re-weigh food. Most underreporting is in oils and nut butters.

2. Add 250 ml whole milk + 30 g oats to a daily shake (~250 kcal).
3. Move pre-workout snack to a full second lunch.
4. Audit sleep — under 7 h kills appetite and recovery.

Gaining too fast (>500 g/week sustained for 3 weeks)

1. Drop pre-workout snack by 100 kcal.
2. Trim one dinner carb portion by 50 g rice.
3. Hold for 2 weeks. Re-evaluate.

GI distress from high volume

1. Split meals smaller and more frequent (5–6 instead of 4).
2. Reduce raw cruciferous vegetables, cook them instead.
3. Soak legumes overnight, rinse twice.
4. Take meals with 250 ml water, not a liter.

Low appetite

- Use calorie-dense additions: nut butters (20 g = 120 kcal), olive oil (15 ml = 130 kcal), dried fruit (40 g = 130 kcal), full-fat dairy.
- Liquid calories: 500 kcal smoothie (200 ml milk + 30 g oats + 30 g whey + 1 banana + 30 g peanut butter).
- Stop training fasted — kills daily intake.

Travel

- Default to the airport fallback meal.
- Long flights: pre-pack 2 chicken-rice containers (TSA-allowed when sealed and frozen). Pack whey.
- Hotel room: rice cooker + microwaveable rice pouches + canned tuna + greens from the grocery is a 700-kcal meal in 8 min.

Illness

- Cut volume by 30%. Protein unchanged. Carbs to support recovery. Drop training, not eating.

Social events

- Eat 80% of your target before going. Drink water-spaced alcohol (1:1).
- Beer is 150 kcal/can — count it. Wine 120 kcal/glass.
- One day off-plan in 14 will not derail you. Two will.

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Built for TJFit Hypertrophy 12-Week Mesocycle. Cook the food. Lift the weight. Sleep eight hours. The rest follows.